FLEET TEAM DIGEST

737MAX-FTD-09-17001

Issue Title : Towing with steering lockout pin installed in the wrong location

Airplane Model	ATA	Minor Model(s)
737MAX	0910-00	-7, -8, -8200, -9, -BBJ

Other Model(s)	ECCN
737NG	9E991

Originated Date	Last Revised Date	Created On
05/02/2017	05/02/2017	04/21/2017

Estimated Completion Date	Next Update Date

Applicability

All 737MAX airplanes.

Description

When towing a 737MAX airplane, the nose wheel steering system is depressurized by operating a tow lever on the nose wheel steering metering valve and inserting a lockout pin in the lever to hold it in the "steering depressurized" position.

Two 737NG operators reported inadvertently installed this steering lockout pin into a rig pin hole (NWS 4) on the steering metering valve instead of in the tow lever handle. See attached graphic. With the lockout pin installed in the rig pin hole, the steering system was not actually depressurized when the airplane was towed. The operators were concerned that damage might have occurred while towing in this configuration.

Status

N/A

Interim Action

N/A

Final Action

Under most circumstances, towing with a pin inadvertently installed in the NWS4 rig pin location instead of in the tow lever will not damage the steering system or other nose gear components. The reason is that the cable system is still free to move as the nose gear turns and the steering metering valve is held in the neutral position by the pin so the steering system will not be able to try to recenter the gear once towing begins.

While damage is unlikely to occur, it is recommended that operators review recommended towing procedures in the AMM. Also, please note that there is a large placard on the left side of the plastic nose wheel steering metering valve cover that shows how to operate the steering depressurization tow lever and the lockout pin.

As a result, Boeing does not plan any changes to the airplane hardware or to the AMM.

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Operator Action

Boeing recommends that operators review recommended towing procedures as contained in the noted AMM section.

Reference Categories

Reference Type	Reference Number	Revision Number	Reference Date
Aircraft Maintenance Manual (AMM)	09-10-00 (Towing)		

Parts List

Part Name	Boeing Part Number	Supplier Name	Supplier Number
Lock pin, nose gear towing lever	A09003-2		

Related Categories

- In Service Occurrences : null

Attachments:

a) Steering Metering Valve Tow Provisions

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